

company) would be 315,000 rupees per annum with medical, superannuation benefits provided additionally. Entry-level freshers will undergo foundational competency training (three months) and domain hands-on training (six months). Then they will have opportunities to work in software development and testing in the telecom embedded system domain."

As per figures provided by TimesJobs.com, 48% of the engineers working in telecom sector, who are basically freshers, get anywhere between 80,000 and 300,000 rupees per annum. Middle-level 25% engineers draw anywhere between 400,000 and 700,000 rupees per annum and senior 15% engineers are paid one million rupees and above.

According to PayScale.com, a telecom engineer earns an average salary of 403,545 rupees per annum. Experience does have a moderate effect on pay in this sector. A skill in network management or administration is associated with higher pay for the job. But a telecom network engineer earns an average salary of 359,426 rupees per annum. The skills that increase pay for this job the most are an understanding of GSM and telecom. Most people with this job profile move on to other positions after about ten years in this sector.

## Minimum qualification required

Ideally, telecom companies look for graduates (B.E./B.Tech in ECE/CS/Telecom) with good academic record of anywhere between 60% and 70% aggregate in all papers in engineering and having cleared in first attempt. Some companies also recruit EEE and IT graduates and provide necessary training.

## Demand areas

Going by the statistics provided by TimesJobs.com, Bengaluru tops the list of top five cities hiring engineers for telecom sector, with a share of 28%. Second in the list comes Delhi with 16% of the jobs. Mumbai falls next with 13% while Chennai and Pune share 11% of the jobs each.

Understandably, a big chunk of

## You could be a network optimisation engineer (NPO)...

### Responsibilities and tasks:

As a network optimisation engineer your role would be to provide network performance services covering a variety of tasks, such as network performance audits, quality and capacity optimisation, parameter planning, network feature planning, network statistics analysis, troubleshooting and performance management. You must be willing to work in late shifts if the project demands. Customer focused mindset and process orientation are important for providing the services with high quality. You should have relevant work experience in mobile telecommunication area and solid background with GSM systems. Any 3G/WCDMA working knowledge would be a definite plus. This role requires practical knowledge of radio network planning and optimisation tasks throughout the network planning process. Working knowledge of NSN system and tools would be an added advantage.

### Position requirements:

- Positive attitude, teamwork, focus on the customer's demand, consulting approach, quality orientation, ability to work in matrix organisations and effective communication skills, planning, organisation and executing skills
- Good communication and documentation skills
- Ability to handle customer meetings and discussions

## Professional Courses for Telecom Domain

### Certified course for a telecom infrastructure engineer

1. Communication Basics of Telecom
2. GSM Channels & Implementation
3. CDMA Introduction in Telecom
3. Telecom Site Introduction
4. Telecom Equipments & Materials
5. Complete 3G Solution
6. Introduction to Operation & Maintenance (O&M)
7. Telecom Network Solution (NOC)
8. Complete RF Section
9. Telecom Management Solution
10. Paper Formalities and Report Generation

### Extra:

1. Group Discussion and Aptitude Test Preparation
2. Practical Site Exposure

### Certified telecom course for a network engineer

1. Communication Basics of Telecom
2. Basics of Telecom Networks
3. Telecom Network Switching
4. CCNA (Cisco Certified Network Associate) Basics, Advanced and Lab Training
5. Unix Basic and Advanced Level

### Extra:

1. Personality Development Programme

the jobs for engineers is in software domain; 22% of the jobs being for software engineers and application programmers each. Roughly 8% of the jobs are in areas of RF engineering and hardware installation or maintenance. About 7% of the jobs are for network administration.

## Professional courses could be an option

Although some companies have their own in-house training facilities to train new entrants, the others look for candidates with some kind of experience or formal training in the subjects. There are a handful of organisations that provide professional certification courses in India. Typically, these training programmes are designed to give candidates an overview of communication, GSM and CDMA systems. These

## Notable hiring companies

- Nokia Solutions and Network
- Wipro
- Ericsson
- Tata Communications
- Alcatel-Lucent
- Avion
- HCL

provide a more practical approach towards the telecom industry.

There are several professional courses for telecom domain with duration of one to six months. Depending on your field of interest, you could go for that particular course. In the programme structure, the topics that are touched upon during these courses are highlighted in the box below. These could, again, vary from one institute to another, some of whom also provide placement and guidance. ●

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